



Right Away

Our December 2026 link — what changes for you, in plain English

A proposal for discussion · CEA link · 24 weeks · code FR-24-F34s

The short version

Five things to take away if you remember nothing else

35h

**the same
contracted
week**

no extra hours

6

**most days in a
row**

today 7, up to 9

6 in 24

**full weekends
off**

one in four, not
one in five

3

**never fewer on
the station
floor**

today it can drop
to 2

30–60

**minutes off
every closing
shift**

an hour on a
Saturday

Same hours, shorter closing shifts, more weekends — and staff where the trains are.

Why the link has to change

Nobody is changing it for the sake of it



A new timetable in December 2026

More trains, at new times — the link has to follow them.



More of us on the link

It grows from 20 weeks to 24, so four more colleagues join it.



New staffing levels

At least 10 on a Sunday, and more at the open and the close. We also aim for 14 on a Saturday.



The ticket office in fixed pairs

Two early and two late, on the same shifts, every day.

Will I work more?

The first thing everyone asks

	Today	Right Away
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Contracted days at work a week	4.2	4.17
Contracted days at work a year	219	217

No. Exactly the same 35-hour week — and about 2 fewer contracted days a year.

Will my basic pay change?

Basic pay follows your contracted hours

	Today	Right Away
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Saturdays a year, at time and a quarter	26	30
Sunday overtime to share — each, a year	21	22

No. The same 35-hour week — plus about four more Saturdays at time and a quarter.

Will my shifts be longer?

Every closing shift gets shorter — the average goes up six minutes

	Today	Right Away
Weekday closer — starts 15:45, not 15:15	8h 40m	8h 10m
Saturday closer — starts 15:45, not 14:45	9h 10m	8h 10m
Sunday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:30	8h 55m	8h 10m
Longest shift anywhere	9h 10m	9h 30m
Average shift	8h 14m	8h 20m

Every closing shift is 30 to 60 minutes shorter — but some earlies run longer.

Will I finish late more often?

Yes — about one extra late finish every two or three weeks

	Today	Right Away
Finishing at 23:00 or later — each, a year	39	59
Finishing at 22:00 or later — each, a year	78	91
Starting at 06:20 — each, a year	62	65
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	14h 05m

December needs more people at the close — but every closing shift is shorter.

Will I know the times?

17 shift times in all — 5 of them you already work

17

shift times in all

today there are 18

5

you already work

listed below

12

are new

the next slide lists them



You work these today

06:20–13:45 · 06:20–14:20 · 06:20–14:50 · 14:00–22:30 · 14:30–22:00

One fewer shift time than today (17, not 18) — but 12 are new, so there is more to learn.

The 12 new times

By day, and how each one compares with today

Weekdays

06:20–14:30

off at 14:30, not 14:20

06:20–15:45

a long early, 9h 25m

07:00–16:15

a new early, 9h 15m

14:00–21:00

a short late, 7h

15:45–23:55

the closer, 30 min later

Saturday

06:20–15:30

off at 15:30, not 14:50

07:15–16:45

a new early, 9h 30m

14:45–22:45

a new late, off by 22:45

15:45–23:55

the closer, an hour later

Sunday

07:15–15:30

the opener, 15 min shorter

09:00–18:00

a new early, 9 hours

14:30–22:30

the ticket-office late

15:15–23:25

the closer, 45 min later

Some are small nudges; some are genuinely new, including earlies of 9h 15m to 9h 30m.

Rest and weekends

The biggest improvement over today

	Today	Right Away
Full weekends off	4 in 20	6 in 24
Most days worked in a row	7 (up to 9)	6
Rest-day breaks of two days or more	13 of 17	22 of 24
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	14h 05m
Weeks on one turn, Monday to Friday	7 of 16	14 of 20

A weekend off one week in four, never more than six days on, and more rest.

Earlies, lates and Sundays

The balance you have now stays the same



Half earlies, half lates

The same split as today: every early Monday to Saturday is matched by a late.



Sundays are still overtime

Not part of the contract, same as now — and about the same number of Sundays as today.



Nobody past 23:25 on a Sunday

The Sunday finish stays where it is. That is agreed practice and will remain so.

No shift in the balance of earlies and lates. Sundays stay overtime and still finish at 23:25.

Booking leave

What 14 days of annual leave buys you, with Sundays off

	Today	Right Away
Days off in a row — best place to book	30	28
Days off in a row — on average	23.4	23.6
Days off in a row — worst place	19	20
Leave needed for four full weeks off	14	15

About the same. A cover week still counts as 4 days of leave, exactly as now.

More staff on the floor

More people on duty with you, all day

	Today	Right Away
On duty on a weekday	11–12	14
On duty on a Saturday / Sunday	10 / 8	14 / 10
Fewest ever on the station floor	2	3
Avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota	4 (up to 5)	0

Never fewer than three on the floor, and no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

The honest trade-offs

Nothing is free — here is what it costs

Twelve new shift times to learn

Five of today's times stay — slide 9 lists the new.

Some longer earlies

The longest shift is 9h 30m, a Saturday early (today 9h 10m).

Best leave stretch: 28 days, not 30

Average and worst: about the same as today.

Shifts 6 minutes longer on average

That is what buys two fewer contracted days.

More late finishes

About 59 a year each at 23:00 or later, against 39 today.

Still a proposal

Your views count before a link is chosen, and who goes on which line is not decided.

At a glance

Today's roster and Right Away, side by side

	Today	Right Away
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Contracted days at work a year	219	217
Average shift · longest shift	8h 14m · 9h 10m	8h 20m · 9h 30m
Closing shift: weekday · Saturday · Sunday	8h 40m · 9h 10m · 8h 55m	8h 10m · 8h 10m · 8h 10m
Full weekends off	4 in 20 (one in five)	6 in 24 (one in four)
Most days worked in a row	7 (up to 9)	6
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	14h 05m
Different shift times	18	17 (5 you know)
On duty weekday · Saturday · Sunday	11-12 · 10 · 8	14 · 14 · 10
Avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota	4 (up to 5)	0

Same hours, fewer contracted days, shorter closers, more weekends, more colleagues.



What happens next

1. Look at the full proposal sheet — page 3 shows every week of the link
2. Tell us what worries you, even if it is small
3. Your feedback goes to the managers with the proposal

Right Away · FR-24-F34s · every figure worked out from the rota by the Marylebone Roster app